Transforming Internal Communication with Internal Social Media and AI

Listening across the organization

Internal social media can create a shared communication space where employees see one another's contributions, respond to colleagues and build on ideas over time. The webinar illustrates how a discussion thread can surface a need that might otherwise stay local: employees exchange observations about products for younger customers, colleagues add further perspectives, and managers invite contributors to help develop a response. The example shows the potential of visible, persistent employee discussion to support listening and participation.

The academic presentation describes internal social media as one part of a broader listening architecture. Listening is not simply collecting comments: employees need respectful responses. A routine reply that redirects a concern into a process without addressing it can feel like "pseudo listening"; a response that acknowledges the concern and explains what is known can show respect even when there is no immediate solution.

The practitioner presentation demonstrates possible uses of AI with internal social media, including summarizing discussions, identifying themes, preparing executive briefs and informing change planning. These demonstrations used a constructed example thread, so they illustrate possible workflows rather than prove results from a live organization.

What this means for practice

- Make employee participation easy and ensure contributions receive meaningful responses.
- Use AI-generated summaries as prompts for investigation, not as a complete or neutral account of employee opinion. A small number of active posters may not represent everyone.
- Compare platform signals with other evidence, such as surveys and direct conversations.
- Establish clear expectations for privacy, trust, access and responsible AI use. The webinar raises ethical questions but does not examine them in depth.

The opportunity is to use digital discussion and AI to improve organizational understanding while keeping human judgment and respectful listening at the center.

Source: "Using AI and internal social media for dialogue" transcript.